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HIGH HOLIDAY SERVICE GUIDE

ROSH HASHANAH

ראש השנה

Making the High Holiday service easier to follow and understand...

Welcome to the Rosh Hashanah Service

Rosh Hashanah is the anniversary of the day on which G-d completed the creation of this world, by creating Adam and Eve, the first man and woman. Adam’s very first act was to proclaim the Almighty as King of the Universe. He called upon all creatures: Come, let us worship, bow down, and kneel before G-d, our maker. Each Rosh Hashanah, we too proclaim the Kingship of G-d, and reaffirm our commitment to serve Him.

Just as on the original Rosh Hashanah G-d created the world for the first time, so too each Rosh Hashanah He reconsiders and re-evaluates the quality of our relationship with Him, and creates our world anew.

The Holiday of Rosh Hashanah stirs the heart of every Jew. The Jewish New Year is a time of awe and solemnity. On this day we re-establish and intensify our relationship with G-d and are judged, together with all of mankind, for the coming year.

Throughout Rosh Hashanah, we are attuned to the holiness of the day. All our activities - praying in the synagogue, listening to the shofar, and partaking of festive meals - are imbued with an awareness of G-d's Majesty.

On Rosh Hashanah we stand united before the Almighty and pray for a year of health, prosperity and peace. The words we read in the Machzor, the special holiday prayer book, help us channel our thoughts and prayers upward, shaped by the stirring and incisive words of our great Sages. Our hearts are awakened to the awesome power of the day.

Rosh Hashanah means “head of the year.” Just as the head controls the entire body, so does Rosh Hashanah contain within it the potential for life, blessing and sustenance for the entire year. Our actions on Rosh Hashanah set the tone for the year to come. For this reason we are careful in all we think, say and do during these two days.

We pray that G-d, in turn, will grant us a good and sweet year. Our wishes for one another are reflected in the words which we say after services on the first night of Rosh Hashanah, *L’Shana Tova Teichoteiv V’teachatem* – may you be inscribed and sealed for a good year.

We present this Rosh Hashanah Service Guide with the hope that it will enable a better understanding of the various prayers and the order of the service. It is hoped that this guide will serve to enhance your Synagogue experience.

Shana Tova.

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NOTE ABOUT PAGE NUMBERS. The ‘ArtScroll A’ refers to the Ashkenaz edition and the ‘ArtScroll S’ refers to the Sefard edition. The Birnbaum High Holiday Machzor has two editions, a single volume and a two-volume. The Birnbaum page numbers in this guide refer to the single volume edition. ‘Chabad’ refers to the old Chabad Hebrew/English Machzor (usually blue). ‘Annotated’ refers to the Chabad Annotated Edition (red cover) first published 2006.

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	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
1. Kaddish and Borchu	10	50	68	23	26	29

Borchu is recited standing, and with a special bow of the head in reverence to the One and Only G-d. After *Borchu* we may be seated.

2. The Shema (Hear, O Israel)	11	52	70	23	27	30
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The *Shema*, the essence of our faith, is recited at this point. It is customary to cover our eyes with our right hand while reciting the first verse of the Shema, to promote deep concentration.

3. The Amidah	15	62	80	31	30	33
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We rise for the *Amidah*, the prayer in which we pour forth our requests to G-d. Before beginning the *Amidah*, we take three steps back, and then three steps forward as if approaching a king.

4. Concluding Prayers	19	78	96	39	34	39
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We recite *L'David Mizmor* (By David, a Psalm), verse by verse following the Chazan.

This Psalm is dedicated to the majesty of G-d. With the creation of man, G-d became King; as one cannot be a king if He has no subjects to rule. Adam became G-d's first subject and he immediately proclaimed the sovereignty of the Creator: 'King of the Universe.'

For this reason this Psalm has been made an important part of the High Holiday prayers, as Rosh Hashanah is the anniversary of the creation of man, and of the Coronation of the King of kings.

5. Aleinu (It is incumbent upon us)	22	84	100	43	36	42
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This prayer, composed by Joshua, expresses our duty to praise the Creator of the universe Whom we recognise as the sole Ruler of the Creation.

6. [Eve 1] Greeting for Rosh Hashanah	24	90	104	47	38	44
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[Eve 1] It is customary to greet one another with the special greeting: "**L'Shana Tova Tikateiv V'teichatem** – May you be inscribed and sealed for a good year."

Customs for the Rosh Hashanah table

[Eve 1] It is customary to dip a piece of apple into honey following the *Hamotzie* (blessing over bread). A blessing and special prayer are recited.

[Eve 2] It is customary to eat a "new" fruit (not eaten yet this season) following the Kiddush, and the blessing *Shehecheyanu* is recited in addition to the blessing *Ha-etz* over the fruit.

Many families eat additional symbolic foods – such as Challah dipped in honey, honeyed carrots, pomegranates and the head of an animal or fish.

First Day

Rosh Hashanah – Shacharit (morning) Service

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
7. Opening Prayers	63	220	200	133	59	79

The opening prayers are mostly devoted to the expression of thanks for G-d's help and grace.

8. Boruch She-omar (Blessed is He who spoke)	71	222	224	135	70	89
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We rise before reciting, men gather the front two fringes of their prayer-shawl or tzitzit, and hold them in their right hand. We may be seated at the conclusion of this prayer.

9. Ashrei (Happy are those)	72	244	230	153	71	91
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The Psalm of Ashrei introduces a series of songs of praise, written by King David. We take a closer look at the beautiful world we live in, and offer praise to its Maker.

10. Vayevarech David (And David blessed)	76	252	238	161	75	95
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Rise for a set of prayers recounting our exodus from Egypt and praising G-d for His deliverance. Remain standing until after section 7.

11. Hamelech (The King)	80	262	248	169	80	99
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Remain standing as the leader of the Shacharit service takes his place and begins a moving melody describing G-d sitting on His lofty throne.

12. Shir Hama-alot (A song of ascents)	-	264	250	169	81	100
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Psalm 120 describes how G-d indeed answers us when we call out to Him in times of distress.

13. Kaddish and Borchu	81	266	252	171	82	101
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Borchu is recited standing, and with a special bow of the head in reverence to the One and Only G-d. After *Borchu* we may be seated.

14. The Shema (Hear O Israel)	88	290	276	195	86	105
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In preparation for the Shema, men gather all four fringes of their prayer-shawl - The Shema, the essence of our faith, is then recited.

It is customary to cover our eyes with our right hand while reciting the first verse of the Shema, to promote deep concentration.

15. The Amidah	91	296	276	195	89	109
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We rise for the Amidah, the prayer in which we pour forth our requests to G-d. We begin by taking three steps backwards and then three steps forwards, then stand with our feet together for this entire prayer.

16. The Chazan's Amidah Repetition	95	306	292	209	95	115
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The Chazan is about to begin the "repetition of the Amidah", where he will represent us on High and ask G-d to bless us with all good things for the coming year.

We will be his back-up team, responding with "Amen" and joining in at various points, to add impetus to his prayers. **Please remember that whenever the Ark is open, one should stand out of respect.**

17. Yorayti (I am awe-stricken)	95	306	292	211	95	115
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Today is the Day of Judgment, where G-d determines every detail of the coming year. The Chazan will represent us in front of the Supreme King. Before he begins, he will ask G-d's blessing to be successful in this sensitive mission.

18. Ot Chil (The awesome day of reckoning)	96	308	294	211	96	116
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We all read the following paragraph silently. It describes how every being trembles as G-d judges us and plans the blessings or lack thereof, G-d forbid, for the New Year.

First Day

Rosh Hashanah – Shacharit (morning) Service

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
19. Atah Hu Elohei-nu (You are our G-d)	98	314	300	217	98	118

The Chazan will start us off on this interactive prayer that describes G-d's attributes. We will read sets of two phrases each time in advance of the Chazan who will repeat it.

20. Ta-ir V'tari-a (Rise and sound)	99	320	306	239	98	119
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We repeat the following stanzas after the Chazan.

21. Eider Vahod (With pleasure I declare)	100	320	306	241	99	120
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This next section is a song of praise to G-d, enumerating His manifold traits. The Chazan sings each line and we answer with the half-line refrain. Each segment is comprised of three lines. After each set of three lines, we read the sentence that follows.

22. Yishpot Teivel (He will judge)	104	326	312	247	100	124
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We repeat the next two stanzas after the Chazan.

23. Ado-nai Melech (The L-rd is King)	105	328	314	225	101	124
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Structured according to the Hebrew alphabet, the next piece invokes us to proclaim G-d's praises. The Chazan sings each segment and we answer with the refrain "The L-rd is King, the L-rd was King, the L-rd will be King forever and ever."

24. L'eil Orech Din (To the Al-mighty)	106	330	316	261	105	126
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This section describes how G-d judges us during Rosh Hashanah. It is written in the order of the Hebrew alphabet. We repeat the first phrase after the Chazan. We then read the next two phrases and keep reciting two phrases each time ahead of the Chazan.

25. Kedushah	107	332	318	261	106	126
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Kedushah is the prayer in which we sanctify G-d's name and declare Him to be Omnipresent. It is based on the scriptural description of the heavenly rendition of *Kedushah* by the Angels.

Stand with your feet close together for the *Kedushah*, which is said responsively (first Chazan then congregation).

Following the *Kedushah*, one may be seated. The Chazan continues the repetition of the Amidah.

26. Modim (We thankfully)	110	338	324	267	109	130
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Stand and say the small inset paragraph while bowing.

27. Avinu Malkeinu (Our Father, Our King)	210	384	370	271	110	152
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A series of one line verses introduced by the words "Our Father, Our King" reflecting on our relationship with G-d. He is at once our King, and as such is in complete control and has absolute power over us, but nevertheless He is our father, denoting the compassion, love, care and mercy G-d extends to us, despite the fact that we may have erred from His dictates.

This theme, our two-pronged relationship to G-d, is central and integral to Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur, and is continuously reiterated throughout the High Holiday services.

28. Kaddish	113	388	374	275	111	154
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We stand and respond "Amen" as indicated in the Machzor.

This concludes the repetition of the Amidah.

29. Shir Shel Yom (Song of the Day)	38	178	384	99	116	155
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We read the Psalm that was said each day in the Holy Temple. A different Psalm is recited each day.

First Day

Rosh Hashanah – Shacharit (morning) Service

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
30. Removing Torah from the Ark	114	390	386	277	116	160

The removal of the Torahs from the Ark is preceded by the recitation of an extra prayer relating to the Holiness of this day. The *Shelosh Esrai Middot* – Thirteen Attributes of Mercy, the prayer that G-d taught Moses to recite to invoke His mercy and forgiveness following the sin of the golden calf. It is recited three times, followed by a personal supplication for spiritual and physical success and good health.

31. Torah Reading	117	402	398	287	119	164
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The Torah Reading on the first day of Rosh Hashanah relates the miraculous birth of Isaac to Abraham and Sarah at the age of one hundred years and ninety years respectively. Sarah, as well as Rachel and Chanah, were all “remembered” and blessed with children on Rosh Hashanah. We too pray to be remembered and blessed on this special day of Remembrance. An added significance is the message of the continuity and eternity of our nation heralded by the birth of Isaac, the “next generation” of the Jewish People.

32. Maftir	120	412	408	293	121	169
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The Maftir reading is from the portion of the Torah in which G-d commands us regarding the observances of Rosh Hashanah.

33. Hagbah – Lifting of the Torah	120	414	410	293	121	169
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With the conclusion of the reading from the Torah, the Torah is lifted for all to see, and we recite *Vzot Ha-torah* (This is the Torah). This is the same Torah that Moses placed before the children of Israel. Nothing in it has changed. It is as relevant today as it was then.

34. Haftarah	121	416	412	296	122	170
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The first day's Haftarah describes the miraculous birth of Samuel the Prophet to his mother Chanah.

Shofar

The Mitzvah (commandment) to listen to the sound of the Shofar is a Torah obligation with no clear reason given. Nonetheless commentators have offered many explanations on the significance of this Mitzvah.

Rav Saadiah Gaon listed ten perspectives:

1. Rosh Hashanah is the anniversary of Creation, and therefore the anniversary of G-d being declared King over the world. The Shofar sound is associated with a regal coronation.
2. The Shofar sound is a reminder for repentance.
3. The Shofar sound reminds us of our commitment to the Torah, which was given with the sounding of the Shofar.
4. The Shofar sound is synonymous with the warnings of the Prophets.
5. The Shofar sound recalls the war cries of our enemies in destroying the Holy Temple, causing us to pray for its rebuilding.
6. The Shofar sound recalls the binding of Isaac, who was replaced on the altar by a ram (the source of the Shofar).
7. The Shofar sound arouses a sense of awe and reverence within us.
8. The Shofar sound reminds us of the Great Day of Judgement.
9. The Shofar sound reminds us of the great Shofar blast when Moshiach will arrive.
10. The Shofar sound strengthens our belief in the resurrection of the dead which will be accompanied by the blowing of a Shofar.

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
35. Preparatory Psalms	222	432	428	315	127	175

A selection of verses are recited, to pray for the removal of any hindrance to our performance of this monumental Mitzvah.

We begin with *Lamnatzay-ach* (To the choirmaster) which is recited seven times. We are thus repeating the word *Elokim* (G-d) 49 times, purifying the 49 levels of impurity, and thereby emerging worthy of a benevolent judgment.

We continue with *Min Ha-maytzar* (From out of distress). The Chazan recites these eight verses, one by one, and the congregation repeats after him. (The first letters of these verses combine to form the words *Kra Satan*, which, loosely translated, means "abolish the adversary." It is a kabbalistic formulation reserved for this awesome service.)

36. Blowing of the Shofar	223	436	432	317	127	176
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The blessings are then recited by the *Tokea* – the one blowing the Shofar – to which the congregation responds "Amen." The first set of 30 Shofar sounds is then blown while the congregation stands in total silence.

It is imperative that no conversations take place unless directly related to the service, from the beginning of the Shofar blowing until the last set at the end of the Musaf service. Please help us enhance the service for all by adhering to this requirement.

The shofar is blown following a precise order. Each blast connotes a particular emotion.

The three types of blasts sounded are:

1. **Tekiah** – One long clear sound.
2. **Shevarim** – Three short length sounds.
3. **Teruah** – At least nine short sounds.

The long clear *Tekiah* blast, representing G-d's Kingship and dominion, combines with the *Shevarim* and/or *Teruah* sounds, representing our remorse at our inadequacies and failings.

The final *Tekiah Gedolah* – large *Tekiah* signifies a call to action to rectify the situation.

After the initial 30 sounds of the Shofar, the *Tokea* recites the three verses beginning with *Ashrei Ha-am* (Fortunate is the people) one by one, and we repeat after him. King David wrote in the above Psalm: "Fortunate is the people who know the sound of the Shofar." While it may be sufficient to just hear the sound of the Shofar, happy is he who knows and understands its message and meaning.

37. Ashrei (Happy are those)	224	440	436	319	128	177
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The Psalm of *Ashrei*, written by King David offers praise to the creator according to the letters of the Alef Bet.

38. Returning the Torah to the Ark	225	440	436	321	129	178
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The Chazan and Congregation chant while the Torah is carried from the *Bimah* (reading platform) back to the Ark.

First Day

Rosh Hashanah – Musaf Service

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
39. Opening Prayer – Hineni (Here I am)	-	444	440	325	129	178

In this heartfelt prayer, the Chazan expresses his unworthiness to represent the Congregation before G-d, yet beseeches Him to accept his prayers on behalf of the Congregation.

Kaddish is chanted in an ancient melody.

40. The Musaf Amidah	131	448	444	327	130	180
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It is now time for the longest Amidah – or silent conversation with G-d – of the year.

We begin by taking three steps backwards and then three steps forwards, then stand with our feet together for this entire prayer.

All three major themes of Rosh Hashanah are examined in this prayer. *Malchiyot* (majesty) describes how G-d is our King; in *Zichronot* (memory), we call upon G-d to recall our merits; and *Shofrot* (symphony), describes the power of the Shofar.

At the conclusion of each of the above-mentioned sections, the Shofar will be sounded.

41. Repetition of the Musaf Amidah	142	470	460	349	139	193
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The Chazan will now repeat the Amidah. This is an interactive experience and you should try to participate by answering “Amen”, reading the responsive sections marked ‘Congregation,’ and singing along where you can.

Please remember that whenever the Ark is open, one should stand out of respect.

42. Upad Mei-az (From of old...)	142	470	466	349	140	193
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We read this paragraph quietly. It describes how Rosh Hashanah has been a special day since time immemorial.

43. Teifen B’machon (Turn in...)	143	472	468	351	140	195
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Once again, we read the following paragraph quietly. In it, we ask G-d to view us with mercy and to accept our prayers.

44. El Emunah (O faithful G-d)	145	476	472	355	141	196
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We repeat each of the following two stanzas after the Chazan.

45. Ometz Adirei (Even the mighty...)	-	-	-	-	141	196
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We read this paragraph quietly.

It is a very moving *piyut* (poem) that describes how even the greatest spiritual giants in history could not stand up to the scrutiny of G-d’s judgement, much less so ourselves. However, it ends on a positive note: that G-d is not deterred by human shortcomings and will certainly grant us a good new year, even if we do not deserve it.

46. Melech Elyon (Exalted King...)	145	478	474	355	142	198
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Rosh Hashanah is the day that we crown G-d as our king. The next section describes what a great King He is. We repeat the first stanza after the chazan and then each of the remaining stanzas ahead of him.

47. Unetaneh Tokef (Let us proclaim...)	146	480	476	361	144	200
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This awe-inspiring and perhaps best known prayer of the High Holiday liturgy is attributed to Rabbi Amnon of Mainz (Germany), who was tortured at the hands of the bishop of Mainz for staying true to Judaism, and with his dying breath recited this prayer. Three days later he appeared to Rabbi Kalonymos ben Meshullam in a dream, and requested that he encourage all of Jewry and to insert this prayer into the Rosh Hashanah liturgy. Rabbi Amnon’s wish was carried out and soon it was also included in the Yom Kippur liturgy as well.
(See more on next page)

(continued from previous page)

This prayer has three sections. It first describes the scene in heaven on this Day of Judgement; the total recollection of every action and individual attention to each person. The second part describes the uncertainty of life itself, both in terms of quantity of years lived and quality of life experienced. The third part proclaims G-d's patience in awaiting the repentance of each individual, and appeals to Him to consider our own helplessness to mitigate any harsh judgement.

The prayer is punctuated by our own declaration that the three ways to averting a severe judgement are *Teshuva*, *Tefillah*, *Tzedakah* – Repentance, Prayer and Charity. The level of sincerity involved when considering and deciding upon these factors is obviously the crucial issue for us on Rosh Hashanah. Are we ready to reconsider our ways and re-evaluate? Are we sincere and committed in our prayer? Do we really involve ourselves in communal and charitable works?

On this special day we have the unique, G-d given opportunity to change ourselves and advance our lives by focusing on these vital issues.

48. Kedushah	148	486	482	363	145	201
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Kedushah is the prayer in which we sanctify G-d's name and declare Him to be Omnipresent. It is based on the scriptural description of the heavenly rendition of Kedusha by the Angels.

Stand with your feet close together for the *Kedushah*, which is said responsively (first Chazan then congregation).

Following the *Kedushah*, one may be seated. The Chazan continues the Amidah repetition.

49. Vechol Ma'aminim (And all believe...)	149	490	486	367	145	203
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We stand and declare that we are "*Ma'aminim B'nei Ma'aminim* – believers, the children of believers." We proclaim our complete faith in G-d in this section. It is worth reflecting at this point on the extent of our own faith – whether we are guilty of only using G-d as the One to blame when things go wrong, or whether we have faith and trust in His supervision, guidance and direction of the world.

We will repeat the first phrase after the Chazan and then read sets of two phrases each ahead of the Chazan.

50. Repetition of the Amidah continues	151	494	490	371	146	204
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You may be seated.

Over the next series of paragraphs, the Chazan expresses our wish that G-d be clearly realised by us as the Supreme King. He will also read an overview of the Rosh Hashanah offerings in the Temple.

51. Aleinu (It is incumbent...)	154	500	496	377	149	207
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When we say *Aleinu*, we submit ourselves to G-d as subjects would to their King. To illustrate this, we prostrate ourselves to G-d during this prayer.

When you say the words "*Va-anachnu Korim*" (But, we bend the knee), you should kneel. At the word "*Umishtachavim*" (bow down), you should bend over so that your forehead touches the ground. Complete the sentence in this position, then stand for the remainder of the prayer.

Women may simply bow their heads if they prefer.

52. Malchiyot (Majesty)	155	500	502	379	150	208
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This section describes G-d's kingship and dominion over creation.

G-d is the incomparable King of the Universe. The destiny of humanity is to come to this realization. Whereas human kings rule in accordance with the principle of: "might makes right," G-d is the Holy King, Who is, at the same time, beyond comparison in His power, "whatever He wills, He can do," yet He is also the Father of the orphan and the Judge of the widow, Who is always on the side of the powerless.

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
53. Shofar/Hayom Harat Olam (Today is...)	157	508	504	383	152	210

The Shofar is sounded, following which we all chant this paragraph, which describes Rosh Hashanah as the birthday of the world and the awesome day of judgement.

54. Zichronot (Memory)	158	510	506	385	152	210
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In this section we ask G-d to remember us in a positive light.

We recognize that G-d is above Time, and the idea of "forgetting" does not apply to Him, nor is He limited in "understanding" the inner thoughts of His creatures. Nevertheless, we ask that He "remember" only the "good" in our behalf when He Judges us.

All of humanity, indeed the whole world, is Judged today, and we ask that He "remember" the faith of Noach who endured taunts and threats for 120 years while he built the Ark, and tried to explain its purpose to his wayward generation.

For the Jewish People in particular, we ask that He "remember" the early loyalty of our People, who followed Him as a bride, as He said "I remember your youthful devotion, the love of your bridal days, how you followed Me through the desert, in a barren land" (Yirmiyahu 2:2) and later as a precious child, "Is it because Ephraim is my favorite son, my beloved child? As often as I speak of him, I remember him fondly. My heart yearns for him, I will have pity on him, says the L-rd." (Yirmiyahu 31:19)

Most of all, we ask that He "remember" the supreme act of devotion performed by our fathers Avraham and Yitzhak, where Avraham suppressed his natural feelings of mercy towards his son, and was prepared to sacrifice him at the command of G-d, and Yitzhak was prepared to be sacrificed, thereby suppressing his natural feelings of self-preservation, in fulfillment of G-d's command. So should G-d suppress, so to speak, His *Midat HaDin*, His attribute of strict justice, which would require that we be punished for our misdeeds, in favour of His *Midat HaRachamim*, His attribute of mercy.

55. Shofar/Hayom Harat Olam (Today is...)	160	514	510	389	155	213
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The Shofar is sounded, following which we all chant this paragraph, which describe that Rosh Hashanah is the time when G-d judges the world.

56. Shofrot (Symphony)	160	516	512	389	156	213
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This section describes the power of the Shofar.

We recall the time that G-d revealed Himself on Mt. Sinai and gave us the Torah. "The whole world trembled at Your Presence, Creation shook in awe before You, when You, our King, did reveal Yourself on Mt. Sinai to give to Your People the Torah and its Commandments, letting them hear Your majestic voice, Your holy words out of flashes of fire. Amid thunder and lightening did You reveal Yourself to them, amid the sound of the Shofar did you appear to them."

The Shofar will be blown during the final battles of Israel with its enemies. It will be sounded when those in Exile will return. It will be sounded when the Temple will be rebuilt. It is the sound signifying the Presence of the majesty of G-d. We ask that it be sounded speedily with the arrival of the Moshiach.

57. Shofar/Hayom Harat Olam (Today is...)	162	520	516	393	158	215
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The Shofar is sounded, following which we all chant this paragraph, which describe how on Rosh Hashanah G-d judges us either like children if we have been doing His Mitzvot, or as servants if we have not. Either way, we ask G-d to have mercy on us – like a loving father or a like a benevolent master.

58. Modim (We thankfully)	163	522	518	395	159	216
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Stand and say the small inset paragraph while bowing.

First Day

ROSH HASHANAH MUSAF SERVICE

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
59. Birkat Kohanim (Priestly Blessing)	164	524	520	397	160	218

The Kohanim now bless the community. The Kohanim are the purveyors of peace and blessing from G-d to His people, and as such ascend to the platform by the Ark to recite the priestly blessing.

We avoid looking at the Kohanim at this time, however one should not turn their back to the Kohanim. Men may cover their face with their Tallit. Children often enjoy the special feeling of standing with their father underneath his Tallit. When the Kohanim conclude each of the verses, we answer "Amen."

As the Kohanim return to their places, it is customary to thank them with the words, "*Yishar Koach*" (may you have strength).

60. Hayom T'amtzeinu (On this day...)	166	532	528	405	161	220
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We are about to conclude the Musaf prayer, confident that G-d has sealed us for a good year. We repeat the first phrase after the Chazan and then read one phrase ahead of him for the rest of this section.

After the Chazan says each phrase, we answer "Amen."

61. Kaddish	167	584	576	407	162	244
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We stand and respond "Amen" as indicated in the Machzor.

This concludes the repetition of the Amidah.

62. Ein Kelo-heinu (There is none...)	168	586	578	409	162	245
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This closing prayer – using four different names to describe G-d – is recited to show our gratitude and thanks to G-d for answering our prayers.

63. Aleinu (It is incumbent upon us)	169	590	584	415	164	247
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This prayer, composed by Joshua, expresses our duty to praise the Creator of the universe whom we recognise as the sole Ruler of the Creation.

Tehillim

It is customary to use any spare time on Rosh Hashanah to recite Psalms, entreating G-d to listen to our prayers.

64. Shofar	-	-	-	417	180	263
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It is customary to sound an additional 30 sounds of the Shofar in order to confuse the *Satan* – negative energies. In addition, it benefits those who may have missed the first 30 or the full 100 sounds.

Second Day

Rosh Hashanah – Shacharit (morning) Service

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
65. Opening Prayers	63	220	200	133	59	79

The opening prayers are mostly devoted to the expression of thanks for G-d's help and grace.

66. Boruch She-omar (Blessed is He who spoke)	71	222	224	135	70	89
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We rise before reciting, men gather the front two fringes of their prayer-shawl or tzitzit, and hold them in their right hand. We may be seated at the conclusion of this prayer.

67. Ashrei (Happy are those)	72	244	230	153	71	91
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The Psalm of Ashrei introduces a series of songs of praise, written by King David. We take a closer look at the beautiful world we live in, and offer praise to its Maker.

68. Vayevarech David (And David blessed)	76	252	238	161	75	95
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Rise for a set of prayers recounting our exodus from Egypt and praising G-d for His deliverance. Remain standing until after section 7.

69. Hamelech (The King)	176	262	248	169	80	99
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Remain standing as the leader of the Shacharit service takes his place and begins a moving melody describing G-d sitting on His lofty throne.

70. Shir Ha-ma-a lot (A song of ascents)	-	264	250	169	81	100
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Psalm 120 describes how G-d indeed answers us where we call out to Him in times of distress.

71. Kaddish and Borchu	177	266	252	171	82	101
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Borchu is recited standing, and with a special bow of the head in reverence to the One and Only G-d. After Borchu we may be seated.

72. The Shema (Hear O Israel)	183	290	276	195	86	105
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In preparation for the Shema, men gather all four fringes of their prayer-shawl - The Shema, the essence of our faith, is then recited.

It is customary to cover our eyes with our right hand while reciting the first verse of the Shema, to promote deep concentration.

73. The Amidah	186	296	276	195	89	109
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We rise for the Amidah, the prayer in which we pour forth our requests to G-d.

74. The Chazan's Amidah Repetition	190	342	328	229	95	132
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The Chazan is about to begin the "repetition of the Amidah", where he will represent us on High and ask G-d to bless us with all good things for the coming year.

We will be his back-up team, responding with "Amen" and joining in at various points, to add impetus to his prayers.

Please remember that whenever the Ark is open, one should stand out of respect.

75. Atitie L'chananach (I have come to implore you)	190	342	328	229	95	133
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The Chazan prays to succeed in earning us a good year.

76. Imratchah Tz'rufah (Your utterance is pure)	191	344	328	231	96	134
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We read the following paragraph silently, asking G-d to remember the immense dedication that our forefather, Avraham, showed to Him. We pray to earn a blessed New Year in Avraham's merit.

Second Day

Rosh Hashanah – Shacharit (morning) Service

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
77. Atah Hu (You are our G-d)	194	352	338	239	98	136

The Chazan will start us off on this interactive prayer that describes G-d's attributes. We will read sets of two phrases each time in advance of the Chazan who will repeat it.

78. Ta-ir V'tarie-ah (Rise and sound the Shofar)	195	354	340	-	98	136
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Repeat each of the following segments after the Chazan.

79. Eider Vahod (With pleasure I declare)	196	356	342	241	99	138
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This next section is a song of praise to G-d, enumerating His manifold traits. The Chazan sings each line and we answer with the half-line refrain. Each segment is comprised of three lines. After each set of three lines, we read the sentence that follows.

80. Adon Im Maasim (Master...)	201	366	352	251	100	142
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We repeat the next two stanzas after the Chazan.

81. Melech Elyon (Exalted King)	201	366	352	251	101	142
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We will now describe the greatness of the Supreme Monarch, each time echoing that He will reign forever. We will repeat the first stanza after the chazan and then say one stanza ahead of him for the remainder of this prayer.

82. Hashem Melech (G-d is King)	203	370	356	255	103	144
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We read how the celestial beings praise G-d's greatness. The Chazan sings each segment and we answer with the refrain "The L-rd is King, the L-rd was King, the L-rd will be King forever and ever".

83. Kedushah	205	374	360	261	106	147
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Kedushah is the prayer in which we sanctify G-d's name and declare Him to be Omnipresent. It is based on the scriptural description of the heavenly rendition of *Kedushah* by the Angels.

Stand with your feet close together for the *Kedushah*, which is said responsively (first Chazan then congregation). Following the *Kedushah*, one may be seated. The Chazan continues the Amidah repetition.

84. Modim (We thankfully)	208	380	366	267	109	150
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Stand and say the small inset paragraph while bowing.

85. Avinu Malkeinu (Our Father, Our King)	210	384	370	271	110	152
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A series of one line verses introduced by the words "Our father, Our King" reflecting on our relationship with G-d. He is at once our King, and as such is in complete control and has absolute power over us, but nevertheless He is our father, denoting the compassion, love, care and mercy G-d extends to us, despite the fact that we may have erred from His dictates.

This theme, our two-pronged relationship to G-d, is central and integral to Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur, and is continuously reiterated throughout the High Holiday services.

86. Kaddish	212	388	374	275	111	154
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We stand and respond "Amen" as indicated in the Machzor.

This concludes the repetition of the Amidah.

87. Shir Shel Yom (Song of the Day)	35	170	376	91	112	155
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We read the Psalm that was said each day in the Holy Temple. Each day of the week a different Psalm is read.

Second Day

Rosh Hashanah – Shacharit (morning) Service

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
88. Removing Torah from the Ark	213	390	386	277	116	160

The removal of the Torahs from the Ark, is preceded by the recitation of an extra prayer relating to the Holiness of this day: The *Shelosh Esrai Middot* – Thirteen Attributes of Mercy, the prayer that G-d taught Moses to recite to invoke His mercy and forgiveness following the sin of the golden calf. It is recited three times, followed by a personal supplication for spiritual and physical success and good health.

89. Torah Reading	216	402	398	299	119	164
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The Reading on the second day is the Torah's account of the *Akedah* – Binding of Isaac, demonstrating Abraham's and Isaac's readiness to make any sacrifice to fulfill G-d's command. This event took place on Rosh Hashanah, and the merit of this supreme act of devotion is invoked throughout the service, as G-d rewarded this episode with a promise of the perpetual continuity of Abraham's offspring.

90. Maftir	217	412	408	305	121	169
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The Maftir reading from the portion of the Torah in which G-d commands us regarding the observances of Rosh Hashanah.

91. Lifting of the Torah	218	414	408	305	121	169
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With the conclusion of the reading from the Torah, the Torah is lifted for all to see, and we recite *Vzot Ha-torah* (This is the Torah). This is the same Torah that Moses placed before the children of Israel. Nothing in it has changed. It is as relevant today as it was then.

92. Haftarah	219	416	412	305	122	170
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The second day's Haftarah relates G-d's promise to redeem His children and fits in with the theme of Remembrance.

Shofar

The Mitzvah (commandment) to listen to the sound of the Shofar is a Torah obligation with no clear reason given. Nonetheless commentators have offered many explanations on the significance of this Mitzvah.

Rav Saadiah Gaon listed ten perspectives:

11. Rosh Hashanah is the anniversary of Creation, and therefore the anniversary of G-d being declared King over the world. The Shofar sound is associated with a regal coronation.
12. The Shofar sound is a reminder for repentance.
13. The Shofar sound reminds us of our commitment to the Torah, which was given with the sounding of the Shofar.
14. The Shofar sound is synonymous with the warnings of the Prophets.
15. The Shofar sound recalls the war cries of our enemies in destroying the Holy Temple, causing us to pray for its rebuilding.
16. The Shofar sound recalls the binding of Isaac, who was replaced on the altar by a ram (the source of the Shofar).
17. The Shofar sound arouses a sense of awe and reverence within us.
18. The Shofar sound reminds us of the Great Day of Judgement.
19. The Shofar sound reminds us of the great Shofar blast when Moshiach will arrive.
20. The Shofar sound strengthens our belief in the resurrection of the dead which will be accompanied by the blowing of a Shofar.

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
93. Preparatory Psalms	222	432	428	315	127	175

A selection of verses are recited, to pray for the removal of any hindrance to our performance of this monumental Mitzvah.

We begin with *Lamnatzay-ach* (To the choirmaster) which is recited seven times. We are thus repeating the word *Elokim* (G-d) 49 times, purifying the 49 levels of impurity, and thereby emerging worthy of a benevolent judgement.

We continue with *Min Ha-maytzar* (From out of distress). The Chazan recites these eight verses, one by one, and the congregation repeats after him. (The first letters of these verses combine to form the words *Kra Satan*, which, loosely translated, means "abolish the adversary." It is a kabbalistic formulation reserved for this awesome service.)

94. Blowing of the Shofar	223	436	432	317	127	176
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The blessings are then recited by the *Tokea* – the one blowing the Shofar – to which the congregation responds "Amen." The first set of 30 Shofar sounds is then blown while the congregation stands in total silence.

It is imperative that no conversations take place unless directly related to the service, from the beginning of the Shofar blowing until the last set at the end of the Musaf service. Please help us enhance the service for all by adhering to this requirement.

The shofar is blown following a precise order. Each blast connotes a particular emotion.

The three types of blasts sounded are:

4. **Tekiah** – One long clear sound.
5. **Shevarim** – Three short length sounds.
6. **Teruah** – At least nine short sounds.

The long clear *Tekiah* blast, representing G-d's Kingship and dominion, combines with the *Shevarim* and/or *Teruah* sounds, representing our remorse at our inadequacies and failings.

The final *Tekiah Gedolah* – large *Tekiah* signifies a call to action to rectify the situation.

After the initial 30 sounds of the Shofar, the *Tokea* recites the three verses beginning with *Ashrei Ha-am* (Fortunate is the people) one by one, and we repeat after him. King David wrote in the above Psalm: "Fortunate is the people who know the sound of the Shofar." While it may be sufficient to just hear the sound of the Shofar, happy is he who knows and understands its message and meaning.

95. Ashrei (Happy are those)	224	440	436	319	128	177
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The Psalm of *Ashrei*, written by King David offers praise to the creator according to the letters of the Alef Bet.

96. Returning the Torah to the Ark	225	440	436	321	129	178
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The Chazan and Congregation chant while the Torah is carried from the *Bimah* (reading platform) back to the Ark.

Second Day

Rosh Hashanah – Musaf Service

	Adler	ArtScroll A	ArtScroll S	Birnbaum	Chabad	Annotated
97. Opening Prayer – Hineni (Here I am)	-	444	440	325	129	178

In this heartfelt prayer, the Chazan expresses his unworthiness to represent the Congregation before G-d, yet beseeches Him to accept his prayers on behalf of the Congregation.

Kaddish is chanted in an ancient melody.

98. The Musaf Amidah	227	448	444	327	130	180
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The Amidah is the time we stand submissive to G-d, conversing silently, while standing at attention.

We start by taking three steps backwards and then three steps forwards, as if we were walking into the Divine throne-room.

Included in this prayer are the three major concepts: *Malchiyot*, reminding us to accept G-d as our King; *Zichronot*, reminding G-d that we are His people; and *Shofrot*, explaining how the Shofar calls us to remember our responsibilities to Him.

At the conclusion of each of the above-mentioned sections, the Shofar will be sounded.

99. Repetition of the Musaf Amidah	238	536	532	359	139	221
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No Jew is an island. Although the Chazan leads this next part of the service, he doesn't do so alone. Our role is to answer "Amen" aloud and join in at the relevant times.

Today's repetition is somewhat shorter than yesterdays.

Please remember that whenever the Ark is open, one should stand out of respect.

100. L'eil Orech Din (To the Al-mighty)	-	538	534	-	142	222
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This section describes how G-d judges us during Rosh Hashanah. It is written in the order of the Hebrew alphabet. We repeat the first phrase after the Chazan. We then read the next two phrases and keep saying two phrases at a time ahead of the Chazan.

101. Unetaneh Tokef (Let us proclaim...)	146	538	534	361	144	223
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This awe-inspiring and perhaps best known prayer of the High Holiday liturgy is attributed to Rabbi Amnon of Mainz (Germany), who was tortured at the hands of the bishop of Mainz for staying true to Judaism, and with his dying breath recited this prayer. Three days later he appeared to Rabbi Kalonymos ben Meshullam in a dream, and requested that he encourage all of Jewry and to insert this prayer into the Rosh Hashanah liturgy. Rabbi Amnon's wish was carried out and soon it was also included in the Yom Kippur liturgy as well.

This prayer has three sections. It first describes the scene in heaven on this Day of Judgement; the total recollection of every action and individual attention to each person. The second part describes the uncertainty of life itself, both in terms of quantity of years lived and quality of life experienced. The third part proclaims G-d's patience in awaiting the repentance of each individual, and appeals to Him to consider our own helplessness to mitigate any harsh judgement.

The prayer is punctuated by our own declaration that the three ways to averting a severe judgement are *Teshuva*, *Tefillah*, *Tzedakah* – Repentance, Prayer and Charity. The level of sincerity involved when considering and deciding upon these factors is obviously the crucial issue for us on Rosh Hashanah. Are we ready to reconsider our ways and re-evaluate? Are we sincere and committed in our prayer? Do we really involve ourselves in communal and charitable works?

On this special day we have the unique, G-d given opportunity to change ourselves and advance our lives by focusing on these vital issues.

102. Kedushah	148	542	538	363	145	225
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Kedushah is the prayer in which we sanctify G-d's name and declare Him to be Omnipresent. It is based on the scriptural description of the heavenly rendition of Kedusha by the Angels.

Stand with your feet close together for the *Kedushah*, which is said responsively (first Chazan then congregation).

Following the *Kedushah*, one may be seated. The Chazan continues the repetition of the Amidah.

103. Vechol Ma'aminim (And all believe...)	149	546	542	367	145	226
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We stand and declare that we are "*Ma'aminim B'nei Ma'aminim* – believers, the children of believers." We proclaim our complete faith in G-d in this section. It is worth reflecting at this point on the extent of our own faith – whether we are guilty of only using G-d as the One to blame when things go wrong, or whether we have faith and trust in His supervision, guidance and direction of the world.

We will repeat the first phrase after the Chazan and then read sets of two phrases each ahead of the Chazan.

104. Repetition of the Amidah continues	151	550	544	371	146	227
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You may be seated.

Over the next series of paragraphs, the Chazan expresses our wish that G-d be clearly realised by us as the Supreme King. He will also read an overview of the Rosh Hashanah offerings in the Temple.

105. Aleinu (It is incumbent...)	154	554	550	377	149	230
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When we say *Aleinu*, we submit ourselves to G-d as subjects would to their King. To illustrate this, we prostrate ourselves to G-d during this prayer.

When you say the words "*Va-anachnu Korim*" (But, we bend the knee), you should kneel. At the word "*Umishtachavim*" (bow down), you should bend over so that your forehead touches the ground. Complete the sentence in this position, then stand for the remainder of the prayer.

Women may simply bow their heads if they prefer.

106. Malchiyot (Majesty)	156	558	554	381	150	231
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This section describes G-d's kingship and dominion over creation.

G-d is the incomparable King of The Universe. The destiny of humanity is to come to this realization. Whereas human kings rule in accordance with the principle of: "might makes right," G-d is the Holy King, Who is, at the same time, beyond comparison in His power, "whatever He wills, He can do," yet He is also the Father of the orphan and the Judge of the widow, Who is always on the side of the powerless.

He is the incorruptible and righteous judge of the world, who favours no one, and cannot be bribed. He is the true G-d and His word, the Torah, is true and eternal.

107. Shofar/Hayom Harat Olam (Today is...)	157	562	556	383	152	233
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We all chant these two paragraphs, which describe Rosh Hashanah as the birthday of the world.

108. Zichronot (Memory)	158	562	558	385	152	233
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In this section we ask G-d to remember us in a positive light.

We recognize that G-d is above Time, and the idea of "forgetting" does not apply to Him, nor is He limited in "understanding" the inner thoughts of His creatures. Nevertheless, we ask that He "remember" only the "good" in our behalf when He Judges us.

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All of humanity, indeed the whole world, is Judged today, and we ask that He “remember” the faith of Noach who endured taunts and threats for 120 years while he built the Ark, and tried to explain its purpose to his wayward generation.

For the Jewish People in particular, we ask that He "remember" the early loyalty of our People, who followed Him as a bride, as He said "I remember your youthful devotion, the love of your bridal days, how you followed Me through the desert, in a barren land" (Yirmiyahu 2:2) and later as a precious child, "Is it because Ephraim is my favorite son, my beloved child? As often as I speak of him, I remember him fondly. My heart yearns for him, I will have pity on him, says the L-rd." (Yirmiyahu 31:19)

Most of all, we ask that He "remember" the supreme act of devotion performed by our fathers Avraham and Yitzchak, when Avraham suppressed his natural feelings of mercy towards his son, and was prepared to sacrifice him at the command of G-d, and Yitzchak was prepared to be sacrificed, thereby suppressing his natural instinct of self-preservation, in fulfillment of G-d's command. So should G-d suppress, so to speak, His *Midat HaDin*, His attribute of strict justice, which would require that we be punished for our misdeeds, in favour of His *Midat HaRachamim*, His attribute of mercy.

109. Shofar/Hayom Harat Olam (Today is...)	160	566	560	389	155	236
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We all chant these two paragraphs, which describe that Rosh Hashanah is the time when G-d judges the world.

110. Shofrot (Symphony)	160	568	562	389	156	236
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This section describes the power of the Shofar.

We recall the time that G-d revealed Himself on Mt. Sinai and gave us the Torah. "The whole world trembled at Your Presence, Creation shook in awe before You, when You, our King, did reveal Yourself on Mt. Sinai to give to Your People the Torah and its Commandments, letting them hear Your majestic voice, Your holy words out of flashes of fire. Amid thunder and lightening did You reveal Yourself to them, amid the sound of the Shofar did you appear to them."

The Shofar will be blown during the final battles of Israel with its enemies. It will be sounded when those in Exile will return. It will be sounded when the Temple will be rebuilt. It is the sound signifying the Presence of the majesty of G-d. We ask that it be sounded speedily with the arrival of the Moshiach.

111. Shofar/Hayom Harat Olam (Today is...)	162	570	564	393	158	238
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We all chant these two paragraphs, which describes how on Rosh Hashanah G-d judges us either like children if we have been doing His Mitzvot, or as servants if we have not. Either way, we ask G-d to have mercy on us – like a loving father or a like a benevolent master.

112. Modim (We thankfully)	163	572	566	395	159	239
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Stand and say the small inset paragraph while bowing.

113. Birkat Kohanim (Priestly Blessing)	164	574	568	399	160	241
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The Kohanim now bless the community. The Kohanim are the purveyors of peace and blessing from G-d to His people, and as such ascend to the platform by the Ark to recite the priestly blessing.

We avoid looking at the Kohanim at this time, however one should not turn their back to the Kohanim. Men may cover their face with their Tallit. Children often enjoy the special feeling of standing with their father underneath his Tallit. When the Kohanim conclude each of the verses, we answer “Amen.”

As the Kohanim return to their places, it is customary to thank them with the words, “*Yishar Koach*” (may you have strength).

Second Day

Rosh Hashanah – Musaf Service

Adler ArtScroll A ArtScroll S Birnbaum Chabad Annotated

114. Hayom T'amtzeinu (On this day...)	166	582	574	405	161	243
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We are about to conclude the Musaf prayer, confident that G-d has sealed us for a good year. We repeat the first phrase after the Chazan and then read one phrase ahead of him for the rest of this section.

After the Chazan says each phrase, we answer “Amen.”

115. Kaddish	167	584	576	407	162	244
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We stand and respond “Amen” as indicated in the Machzor.

The Shofar is sounded in the middle of the Kaddish.

This concludes the repetition of the Amidah.

116. Ein Kelo-heinu (There is none...)	168	586	578	409	162	245
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This closing prayer – using four different names to describe G-d – is recited to show our gratitude and thanks to G-d for answering our prayers.

117. Aleinu (It is incumbent upon us)	169	590	584	415	164	247
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This prayer, composed by Joshua expresses our duty to praise the Creator of the universe whom we recognise as the sole Ruler of the Creation.

Tehillim

It is customary to use any spare time on Rosh Hashanah to recite Psalms, entreating G-d to listen to our prayers.

118. Shofar	-	-	-	417	180	263
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It is customary to sound an additional 30 sounds of the Shofar in order to confuse the *Satan* – negative energies. In addition, it benefits those who may have missed the first 30 or the full 100 sounds.

*Wishing you a
Shana Tova Umetukah – a good and sweet year
and may you and your loved ones be blessed
with an abundance of health, happiness,
peace and prosperity.*